PYTHON AND AI · EPISODE 06

Your First PyCharm Project

Create, Write and Run Your First Program

KEY POINTS

- A **PyCharm project** is a folder on your disk; you pick its **location** and **name** in **New Project**, with the interpreter type left on **Project venv**.
- **New › Python File** adds the **.py** ending for you. A **#** starts a **comment**: Python skips it, and **Ctrl + /** toggles it.
- In Python, **a new line ends a statement**: no semicolons. Right-click › **Run 'hello'** shows the output in the **Run** window.
- Every project has **.idea** (PyCharm's settings) and **.venv** (its own private Python). Leave both alone.

01 Create a Project

▶ VIDEO 00:21

Home screen › **New › Project…**. Set **Location** to `C:\Users\you\PycharmProjects\hello-python` (the last part is the project's name), untick **Create a welcome script**, leave **Interpreter type** on **Project venv** (**Python version** already shows your Python 3.15), and click **Create**.

02 Find Your Way Around

▶ VIDEO 01:15

Top bar: the menu button (File, Edit, View…); ▷ runs your code, the **bug** starts the debugger. **Left edge**: tool windows such as **Python Console** and **Terminal**; the top one, **Project**, shows or hides the project tree. **Editor**: the big area on the right.

03 Comments

▶ VIDEO 02:20

hello.py — PYTHON

```python
# Show two greetings on the screen
print("Hello World")
print("Hello Python")
```

KEY IDEA

A line starting with **#** is a **comment**: a note for people. Python skips it. **Ctrl + /** comments or uncomments the current line.

04 Write and Run the Code

▶ VIDEO 03:00

Type `pri` and PyCharm suggests **print**; press **Enter** and it adds the brackets, and the closing quote when you type one. Each statement goes on its own line: **no semicolons** (you *can* join two with `;`, but PEP 8, Python's style guide, discourages it). Then right-click in the editor › **Run 'hello'**:

Run

```
C:\Users\you\PycharmProjects\hello-python\.venv\Scripts\python.exe
C:\Users\you\PycharmProjects\hello-python\hello.py
Hello World
Hello Python

Process finished with exit code 0
```

The first line is the same `python <file>` command you typed in the terminal, using the Python inside **.venv**. **Exit code 0** means everything went fine.

05 Inside the Project Folder

▶ VIDEO 04:17

Right-click the project › **Open In › Explorer**: the folder holds `hello.py`, `.venv` and `.idea`.

.IDEA

PyCharm's settings for this project (open files, cursor position). Hidden in the Project window.

.VENV

The virtual environment: this project's own Python. Tools you add stay inside it, so projects can't break each other.

06 Bigger Text

▶ VIDEO 05:11

Alt + Shift + . makes the editor text bigger, **Alt + Shift + ,** smaller. For a size that sticks: **Settings › Editor › Font**, click the *defined in the color scheme* link, set **Size** (e.g. 16) and **Line height** (e.g. 1.5), then **OK**.

CODE 1 file on GitHub github.com/abitclearer/python-and-ai/tree/main/06-your-first-pycharm-project